



BREAKING POINT

Suit of Eyes

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What is this?

Breaking Point: Suit of Eyes is the nineteenth monthly small release for **KULT: Divinity Lost**. This release features nine changes a **Broken** player-character could experience, all of which are based on the KULT Tarot. As the Gamemaster, you are invited to change and adapt them to better fit your story, as well as attach any other effects relevant to what caused the PC to break. Other suits will be released in the near future.



Characters, locations and incidents are portrayed from the metaphorical viewpoint of the **KULT: Divinity Lost** setting.



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VISIONS AND NEEDS

How long does “Brokenness” last? What are its consequences? How will the PCs change? Is this forgettable and/or treatable? The truth of the matter is that these and many more questions have answers unique to each game. It all depends on context, GMing style, campaign themes, the Horror Contract, etcetera.

A splatterpunk themed game might have the player-characters peak momentary madness and frenzy, while a story about altered conscience might require that they remain *Broken* for long periods of time. One is sudden, chaotic, and hyper-violent. The other is calm and surreal. Some groups will gladly delve into the depths of the human mind to explore philosophical questions. Others want nothing but Hollywoodian meltdowns. Maybe you want to experience *Broken* for the sheer power it brings (Enlightenment through Madness), or maybe you’re seeking the discussions about mental health that it sparks (*Broken* as a mental illness). Either way, it is up to each group to define what it looks like in their own campaign.

With that said, here are some questions to help you shape what *Broken* means and looks like. If breaking is meant to be a big part of your story, consider using these questions to expand the Horror Contract before the game begins. This is not a definitive list, so remember to expand on the answers and allow more questions to emerge as needed.

- ◆ What are the main themes of the campaign? How could a *Broken* PC enhance them?
- ◆ How is *Brokenness* experienced under these themes? And for how long?
- ◆ Are there any lingering effects?
- ◆ Is it possible to ever be normal again after breaking?
- ◆ Which additional systems would benefit the story? Maybe additional Player Moves, maybe bonuses or penalties to Attributes, or perhaps none are needed.
- ◆ Which “glimpses of the Truth” could be experienced?
- ◆ Does the Horror Contract limit an aspect of being *Broken*? If so, which aspects and how?

+TAROT+ICA

This release presents ideas based on the Suit of Eyes. These are not the only effects of these cards. Rather, see them as a starting point to develop your own vision. You are of course invited to grab the Tarot Guide (available for free on our website) and brainstorm while reading this document.

Each idea is followed by a suggestion of a new Advantage and Disadvantage the PCs might have access to while *Broken*. It is up to you to determine if they should retain these Moves after “unbreaking”. As a rule of thumb, if you wish to avoid dealing with too many Advantages, it’s wise to ask the Player to erase one of her own before gaining access to the new one. Alternatively, if the player-characters are supposed to remain *Broken* for a short period of time and won’t change dramatically after that, you may want to avoid erasing any Moves. Instead, you could simply keep them locked until the “benefits” of being *Broken* have disappeared. The same applies to Disadvantages.

These changes may or may not happen in conjunction with the GM Moves suggested in the corebook. As per the corebook writing, you don’t have to hand new Advantages to the characters, but it does help to better illustrate what it feels like to Break.

Known Homebrew

Some GMs like to simply activate Disadvantages as if the Player rolled -9 whenever needed. Others, not so much. Some don’t think *Broken* characters are capable of *Keeping it Together*... and, again, others disagree. Truly, *Broken* is a plot device for you to explore KULT’s cosmology more deeply and without restraints. However, if you’d rather have some sort of system to guide you, a widely used homebrew is to maintain the mechanics of Critical Stress whilst *Broken* (penalties to *Keep it Together* and Disadvantage rolls and bonus to *See Through the Illusion*). If these modifiers fit your vision and needs, it would be wise to keep them.

The Suit of the Eyes represents Elysium, the enslavement of our minds and souls. It is also the faith that binds us, the crippling madness, and the rebellious, penetrating insight that lets us see through the Illusion.

1. Elysium

The barriers that kept the character blind to the horrors beyond the veil are broken, leaving her open to profound insight. She sees the true nature of locations and creatures, feels the presence of magic, and it all builds up to a deep understanding that she is in a prison. This insight alerts a powerful lictor in her vicinity, who now must take care of her before she continues to advance in her path of enlightenment. The lictor sets up a mission to capture her and the ones in charge of the operation are vile people who are in it for the power, the glory, and the benevolence of the lictor. Until the character slumbers again or dies, she will face angels, Children of the Night, servants of the Archons, and whoever else wants to collect the bounty by bringing her to the lictor.

Advantage: *Enhanced Awareness* (KDL, p. 114).

Disadvantage: *Enemy* [A lictor] (KDL, p. 99).

2. Imprisonment

Until her *Broken* state is lifted, the character feels trapped, especially when it comes to leaving Elysium. Doors are suddenly, inexplicably, locked. Windows are shut tight, roads take her to the places she wants to flee, extreme weather forces her to stay inside, she is put in quarantine for weeks on end. Imprisonment happens inside the mind as well. It could be that she fails to express how she truly feels, she has recurrent episodes of sleep paralysis, or her ability to understand others is strangely gone for brief moments. Portals to other worlds are sewn shut, and she can't fully *See Through the Illusion* anymore. All she gets are glimpses, quick and cryptic.

Advantage: *Desperate* (KDL, p. 119).

Disadvantage: *Phobia* [Claustrophobia] (KDL, p. 100).

3. Faith

In a fit of maddening epiphany, the character realizes the truth of a Higher Power. She senses its symbolism all around her. It is in the TV, her friends, job, the books she reads, songs, and a myriad of other places. It is everywhere, and she cannot help but feel humbled by it. She sees so much meaning in it that living another truth feels worthy of punishment. Whatever the Higher Power is, she must adhere to its symbolism. Preach it, even. Spread its influence and let it fill her with power, however dangerous this might be for her.

Advantage: Any one that strengthens the Principle within the character and helps her advance its agenda.

Disadvantage: *Bound to Higher Power* (KDL, p. 365).

4. Distractions

The shock pushes the character into the false safety of slumbering. Her mind wants her to forget the horrors seen beyond the veil, the worlds, the creatures, her own twisted self. She blocks it wholly, burying these memories deep in the back of her mind. To others, it is strange how someone went through so much trauma and came out of it well like her. Until her *Broken* state is lifted, the Illusion has full sway over her memories. Distractions continuously compel her to keep these memories hidden. Once the memories return, they come in one sudden and brutal wave that washes over her. The fear, the anxiety, the terrifying intrusive thoughts, it all resurfaces at once. Except that this second time they won't leave; these will push her forward towards the darkness. It becomes a gnawing hunger for more.

Advantage: *Thirst for Knowledge* (KDL, p. 120). Received after the *Broken* state is lifted.

Disadvantage: *Rationalist* (KDL, p. 100).

5. Division

When the dust settles, the character feels torn apart. Lost. Broken. She feels that she needs to change, to grow, to branch out, experiment, and find out who she is. Alone in the peace of her home, Division is present in her reflection on a broken mirror, or the intrusive thoughts about doing the wrong things in her past. In moments of great distress that demand decisive action she must be daring and choose new paths to solve her problems, even when these problem would benefit from tried and true solutions. Division continuously pushes her to accept the idea that there is no way to know who she is. In truth, on a metaphysical level, whatever identity she forges actually belongs to her incarcerated state. Her soul, vibrant and powerful, doesn't want to confine to any of the concepts she desperately wants to hold on to.

Advantage: *Jaded* (KDL, p. 120).

Disadvantage: *Broken* (KDL, p. 96).

6. Rebellion

The character is crushed by the urge to fight the powers that be, dark and ruthless as they are. She senses the presence of a Higher Power and needs to make a stand against it, fighting its influence whenever the chance presents itself. She is an iconoclast tearing down the shackles that bind humanity to the prison. Distancing herself from the Higher Power might push her towards its shadow or other Principles, but it also can set her on a path of enlightenment. Releasing herself from the Principle gives her strength against it.

Advantage: *Opportunist* (KDL, p. 120).

Disadvantage: *Mental Compulsion* [Disrupt the Higher Power's influence] (KDL, p. 99).

7. Madness

The Illusion shatters and the character's soul attempts to escape. Her madness reveals itself physically within her body as a growing ache that pulls her down, spreading pain and agony throughout her mortal shell. Her soul wants the body to change, to reveal its dark glory. Heartburns, joint pains, headaches, fatigue, phantom pains, all of it coupled with bombardments of visions, nightmares, and experiences that show her what's beyond the veil. The very machinery of the Illusion wants to push her out as well, to hide her, to trap her elsewhere. The character finds safety at night, in the silence, underground, or similarly dark places away from humanity. There, she contemplates a warped reflection of her body in puddles, shards of mirrors, and other reflective surfaces; glimpses of her true nature.

Advantage: *Contagious Insanity* (KDL, p. 113).

Disadvantage: *Schizophrenia* (KDL, p. 101) or *Infirm* [Phantom pains] (KDL, p. 113).

8. Visions

The character finds a way to tap into the power locked within her, just beneath the surface of her insanity. She senses the presence of the supernatural and, by concentrating for a few seconds, she may easily peek beyond the veil and catch a glimpse of what is being hidden from her. At will, these visions can be passed on to other people that perform a ritual with her. Typically by joining hands and praying while inside a protective circle, laying next to each other blindfolded while someone spreads incense and chants words of power, or similar moments of silence and contemplation. These images are delivered straight into the mind's eye of whoever joins her, as vivid daydreams full of awe and terror.

Advantage: *Cult Leader* (KDL, p. 113).

Disadvantage: *Broken* (KDL, p. 96).

9. Enlightenment

The character gains insight into one aspect of reality, and she understands that there is more to this world than what meets the eye. She may suspect that we live in a prison, an illusion. Perhaps she becomes aware of the dark powers controlling—blinding—humanity, the influence of another world or Higher Power (such as She Who Waits Below, Inferno, a Dream Prince, or other powers), or her madness or passion gives her insight about dreams, flesh, Time and Space, or death.

The character's Archetype changes to an Enlightened Archetype as per the Advancement rules found in the Core Rules on page 137.



